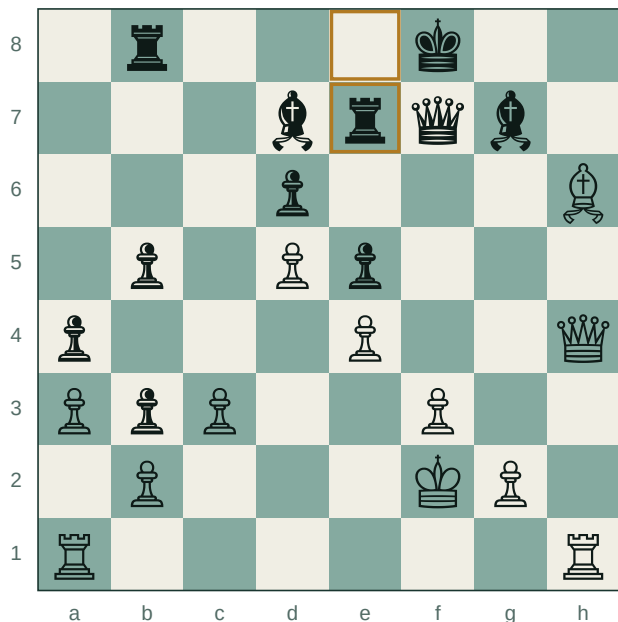


# Clearance tactics: White, move 40

Clearance tactics

White to move



Previous move: 39...Re7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**40. Bxg7+ Qxg7 41. Qh8+ Kf7 42. Qxb8**

**40.Bxg7+** Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. The move also takes the bishop on g7. Recorded reply: **40...Qxg7**.

**41.Qh8+** Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From h8 it attacks king on f8 and queen on g7. Recorded reply: **41...Kf7**.

**42.Qxb8** The queen captures the rook on b8.

At the end, nominal material is White 26 / Black 22 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -1 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on f8. Absolute pin: bishop on g7.